



CAROL BALES

UX STRATEGIST & RESEARCHER

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

With 20 years of experience in UX Strategy and Research, I excel in leveraging human-centered design and data-driven insights to drive user engagement and product innovation. I deliver impactful data and user experiences across diverse industries. My strengths include building and leading high-performing teams, fostering collaborative environments, innovation, and consistently delivering results that enhance product value and customer satisfaction.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, GA
Master of Computer Science, Human-Computer Interaction

University of Tennessee, Knoxville
Bachelor of Fine Arts, Painting

SKILLS

User Research	UX Strategy
UX Design	Usability Testing
Design Thinking	Team Leader
Practice Building	Communication
Requirements	SaaS
Journey Map	Innovation

TOOLS

Alchemer	UserZoom	SPSS
Figma	Mural	Qualtrics
ChatGPT	Trello	Midjourney
Adobe	Invision	UserTesting

CONTACT

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WORK EXPERIENCE

The Weather Company, IBM, GA Oct 2018 – Aug 2023
Sr. Manager, Consumer Insights, Sr. User Researcher

I led a high-volume research team essential to product development and advertising for an audience of 400M.

- Quantitative research to uncover deeper connections between weather and overall well-being. Findings informed the redesign of the TWC app, making it more relevant to day-to-day needs, and a source of deeper insights into personal impacts of various weather conditions.
- Qualitative research to gauge an audience for a weather-oriented newsletter. This research justified the launch of a highly successful newsletter with a loyal audience, generating revenue and brand-equity.
- RITE method of usability testing to refine a new purchase experience for bundled subscriptions. The results eliminated unforeseen, confusing blockers to the purchase process.
- To build the research practice, I created a research repository, started a monthly research showcase, introduced a quarterly UX benchmark, and wrote a customer journey map.

Georgia State University, GA Jan 2018 – May 2023
Adjunct Instructor, Dept of Computer Science

Intro to Human-Computer Interaction: Teams use human-centered design and research practices to iterate toward a prototype.

Silver Spring Interactive, GA Feb 2011 – Sep 2018
UX Designer, Strategist and Researcher

Performed UX Design to solve complex business and user problems. My wireframes served as canonical design requirements and focal points for stakeholder approval.

- UXD for Delta Airline's legacy call-center application resulting in reduced call wait times and call processing times.
- UX Strategy for Y-combinator startup Exception-ALLY.
- UXD and UXR for a decision-support tool for senior living communities (Brookdale Senior Living).
- UX team lead for multiple extensive projects for government, CPG, hospitality, and more.

Fiserv, GA May 2009 – Jan 2011
Sr. UX Architect

- UXD and UXR for a bill-pay call center application focused upon improved efficiency. Our task-based design ensured that key information could be found in 2-3 clicks (down from 8-10)
- User Interviews and data analysis increased search efficiency in Fiserv's biller search API for Walmart Money Centers